

LING 431/531 Gitksan Glossed Data

Group F - Andrew, Matthias, Zahra

Field Methods 2026W1

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Abbreviations

1	first person
2	second person
3	third person
ANIM	animal
ATTR	attributive
CN	common noun connective
CNT.AMOUNT	amount
COM	comitative
COMP	complementizer
DEM	demonstrative
DIST	distal
FOC	focus
HUM	hum
I	Series I person marker clitic
II	Series person marker II suffix
III	Series III person marker pronoun
NMLZ	nominalizer
PL	plural
PN	proper noun connective
PROG	progressive
PROSP	prospective
PROX	proximal
SG	singular
SX	subject extraction
T	Big T
TR	transitive
VAL	valency adjuster

1 Elicitation 2026.09.24

Date: 2026.09.24
Consultant: Hector Hill / Gy'ax
Elicitors: Zahra, Andrew
Location: TFS elicitation room
Context: First elicitation for LING 431/531 Field Methods
Audio: September_25_2026_HH.WAV

1.1 [0:00-14:30]

[4:30]: Discussion of the pronunciation of *we'y/wa'y* – after the glottal is a bit hard to hear but sounds like the unvoiced vowel that Henry had mentioned.

[4:45]: Not positive that suffix is 'y. maybe an allomorph thereof? Note for [4:55] also applies here, as in <https://www.firstvoices.com/gitstenimx/search?q=anoookii%27y&domain=both&types=word%2Cphrase%2Csong%2Cstory>.

Note from the future: the *g* in *anoogi'y* sometimes sounds like a *x*. This is especially clear at [7:32], where Hector pronounces it both ways back to back. [Z: also hearing a bit of labialization on this consonant possibly; but not on the root in isolation as in 5:23.]

- (1) anoogi'y
anoook-i-'y
like-TR-1SG.II
'I like ...'

[4:55]: There is one entry in first voices of *ekstedinii'y* 'I like...' (<https://www.firstvoices.com/gitstenimx/search?q=ekstedinii%27y&domain=both&types=word%2Cphrase%2Csong%2Cstory>).

Some digging reveals that this *ii* is what Henry's grammar (sec. 3.3.2, p. 44) describes as a **transitive vowel**, which is present only with independent transitive verbs, acting as a "inflectional marker of transitivity". Whether this should be written as one vowel (as Henry glosses it) or two (as in the dictionary) I am not sure. I tentatively choose the former.

- (2) ekstedini'y (anaax) tun
ekstedin-i-'y (anaax) tun
like-TR-1SG.II (bread) this
'I like this (bread)'

[5:10]:

- (3) anoogi'y 'nisi'm
anoook-i-'y 'nisi'm
like-TR-1SG.II 2PL.III
'I like you guys'

[5:23]: *anoook* also means 'let/allow'.

- (4) anoogi'y dim yeen
anoook-i-'y dim yee-n
allow-TR-1SG.II PROSP walk-2SG.II
'I let you go/leave'

[5:27]:

- (5) anoogi'y 'niin
 anook-i-'y 'niin
 like-TR-1SG.II 2SG.III
 'I like you'

[5:33]: I very strongly hear a *d* after *siipin*. While *siipin* is not included in the brief lists of Big-T verbs in Rigsby (1986:340) or Hunt (1993:237), I see no other explanation for this, since the root is pretty clearly *siipin*. May want to ask Michael about this.

Consultant comment: refers to *siipintxw* 'lover/friend' (see [5:53]).

- (6) siipin-d-i-'y 'niin
 siipin-t-i-'y 'niin
 like-T-TR-1SG.II 2SG.III
 'I like/love you'

[5:53]: I assume *en-* is the Gigeenix version of nominalizer *an-* in Henry's grammar (sec. 2.2.3.2, p. 5). Hector translates *en-* as 'my', but I could find absolutely no indication of a prenominal possessive with this form. If anything, there is a possessive use of *-(t)xw* mentioned in Henry's grammar (p. 3, fn 3). I don't know what to make of this, but I don't want to write off Hector's intuitions.

Hector also mentions that *ensiipintxw* is difficult to translate to English, as it spans multiple uses.

- (7) ensiipintxw
 en-siipin-txw
 NMLZ-love-VAL
 'My(?) friend/lover'

[Z: ^ I think I do hear the voiceless -'y suffix here, hence the 'my' (and I think that's right about the NMLZ).]

[7:38]: This is extremely difficult for me to transcribe. The sentence is 'I like what you guys are doing (with Gitksan)'. Two things are fairly certain: (1) this contains a headless RC (at least per the translation) (2) it uses a Series II subject suffix *-si'm*, which is characteristic of object extraction (Henry sec. 4.3.3.3, p. 81). To address (1), I chose to include a *=hl*, which can select a RC as per Henry's grammar (p.50). What's problematic is that the only potential *=hl* I hear is after the embedded predicate *yuk* 'to do smthng', while it normally appears before the predicate from which the subject was extracted (cf. ex (107) in Henry's grammar). What's more, *=hl* is a clitic, so it makes no sense that the *-si'm* suffix would follow it. I also don't hear the full pronoun *'nisi'm* here.

Tldr; this transcription is definitely wrong, but I don't know what the correct one is.

- (8) anoogi'y yuhlsi'm (ihl gitksenimx)
 anook-i-'y yuk-hl-si'm (ihl gitksenimx)
 like-TR-1SG.II do-CN-2PL.II (for Gitksenimx)
 'I like what you guys are doing (with/for the Gitksan language)'

[7:53]: Andrew's sentence, confirmed by Hector. Couldn't figure out what *genu* means, but *hloxsa genu gwiikw* is a compound meaning September, literally 'month when the groundhogs get ready for winter' (see First Voices).

At [8:25] Hector translates *hloxsa* as 'month of'. I don't attempt to break the compound down, but the *a* in *hloxsa* could potentially be an attributive marker (ATTR). Henry's grammar (sec. 2.2.4.1, p.8) claims that ATTR can only appear on adjectives, whereas *hloxsa* looks like a noun. However, on p. 3, Henry also says "The attributive suffix *-m/-a* which links modifiers to their modifiees can also attach to nouns (since nouns can modify other nouns)", so there is an inconsistency here.

- (9) anoogi'y hloxsa genu gwiikw
 anook-i-'y hloxsa genu gwiikw
 like-TR-1SG.II month ??? groundhog
 'I like September [=the month when the groundhogs get ready for winter]'

[Scanned dictionary, p.65 : *Hloxsa gennuu gwiikw* 'September'. FV says 'month when the groundhogs get ready for winter,' with spelling *genu* as here (also in Lantz and Turner (2003) ethnobiology paper with the dictionary spelling).]

[8:45]: Hector says that *gwiikw* is also an old term for 'money', but now *dala* is used more often.

[13:42]: *legim anaax* is 'flour', but probably dry flour ([14:13] in audio). *anaax* is 'bread', I don't know what meaning *legim* contributes. [Scanned dictionary: *gigeenix lagim* / *gyeets ligem*.] Also, I assume the distinct *i* in *yelihl* is a transitive marker, but it could also be epenthesizing a vowel to avoid a *lhl* cluster?

Also, at [14:00] Hector says that "you are just saying you are mixing flour", so this likely isn't an imperative construction.

- (10) yelihl legim anaax
 mix-i=hl legim anaax
 like-TR-CN flour
 'You mix flour'

1.2 [14:30-?]

Note we don't have to keep this subsection structure, but am using it to divide transcription times for now.

1.3 [40:00-53:53]

[40:50]: **Context:** *We just finished picking berries, and we want to split it evenly to take back home.*

Is, e.g., take.PL a good way to transcribe plural predicates? Also, Henry glosses *-t* as 3.II, but I believe 3SG.II is more accurate?

- (11) dim mehla dok'm sto'ot
 dim mehla dok-'m sto'o-t
 PROSP each take.PL-1PL.II half-3SG.II
 'We'll take half each'

[41:53]: These were presented by Zahra, second and third were (audibly) confirmed by Hector, not sure about the first.

- (12) a. k'i'y hlak'aphl
 k'i'y hlak'ap=hl
 one piece=CN
 'One piece [of bread]'
- b. k'eeqw gax
 k'eeqw gax
 one rabbit
 'One rabbit'
- c. ky'ulhl gyet
 ky'ul=hl gyet
 one=CN man
 'One man/person'

[42:48]: *wilk'yep* shows up in numbers logically multiplied by 10 (two digit numbers and one hundred), but whether it is morphologically transparent I am not sure. It clearly contains *k'yep* 'ten', but I am unsure whether *wil-* is a morpheme or *wilk'yep* is simply lexicalized. I am also unsure how I'd gloss this, so tentatively using "-ty" (as in twen-ty, thir-ty, etc.)

- (13) *k'yep wilk'yep*
k'yep wilk'yep
 ten "-ty"
 'One hundred'

[43:00]: Hector: "We don't use all those numbers, when I was growing up we were told [very unsure about this transcription, so not glossing for now] *k'eyp xbul k'ap xwsdins* 'fifteen [different animacy bases]'.

Not sure about *wildekhlxw*. First Voices writes "10 x 100 = 1000", but I don't see components of ten or one hundred in here.

- (14) *k'i'y wildekhlxw*
k'i'y wildekhlxw
 one thousand
 'One thousand'

[43:24]: "And that was as far as we were told, because for us, when we say [gloss below, at 43:32] that means we're comparing. So in my family, we were never allowed to do the numbers. When I started the numbers in 2011 here to try to explain what the numbers are. When they started going past five, I was like "what's that?". Even though I heard it, we were never allowed to use it. Comparison means that you're better than, or you're looking down at others, or you put yourself down. So the numbers that you're saying, they're new to me, but to others, they're comfortable in using it. So I could say some things about numbers, but if you ask me if I use them, no."

I am not entirely sure what precedes *gupdiit*, it sounds most like *dii*, but I assume it may be focus marking (*dii*) agreeing with the embedded subject (*-t*). Examples (187), (188) in Henry's grammar both have *dii* at the object extrac-tion site, so may be somehow systematic. The last row in <https://git-grammar.vercel.app/docs/grammar/basics/pronouns> also has a similar-looking construction.

- (15) *gye'a gabiihl* *dii* *gupdiit*
gye'a gabii=hl *dii-t* *gup-dii*
 look how.many=CN FOC-3.I eat-3PL.II
 'Look at all of what they're eating.'

[45:48]: **Context (abridged)**: *Conservationists want to do a precise count of moose in the area. They come up with a number 1,312. How could we say that?*

[48:12]:

- (16) *k'i'y wildekhlxw xadaa*
k'i'y wildekhlxw moose
 one thousand moose
 'One thousand moose'

[49:40]: Hector: "Without the *ii* you are saying one thousand one hundred, instead of saying one thousand **and** one hundred. If you put *ii* that would separate them."

This judgement is tentative. Hector is uncertain whether 1,100 is good with *ii* or not, and it is not yet clear how to actually form 1,100.

- (17) k'i'y wildekhxw k'yep wilk'yep
 k'i'y wildekhxw k'yep wilk'yep
 one thousand ten "-ty"
 'One thousand one hundred [=1,100]'

[52:33]: At [53:23], Hector says that when putting it this way we have to put the *ii* in it, because we are saying "one thousand and one hundred and five".

- (18) k'i'y wildekhxw k'yep wilk'yep xwsdins
 k'i'y wildekhxw k'yep wilk'yep ii xwsdins
 one thousand ten "-ty" and five
 'One thousand one hundred and five [=1,105]'

1.4 [53:53-end]

Ways to say 'the cat meowed' / 'the cat said meow'.

[54:10]:

- (19) sdamkhl duus
 sdamk-hl duus
 make.noise-CN cat
 'The cat meowed'. (spelling from FV gigeenix.)

[54:22]:

- (20) meowhl duus
 meow-hl duus
 meow-CN cat
 'The cat meowed'.

[54:28]:

- (21) yukwhl algyax duus
 yukw=hl algyax duus
 PROG=CN language cat
 'The cat is speaking.'

[54:36]

- (22) yukwhl ayawaatxw duus
 yukw=hl aya-waatxw duus
 PROG=CN cry.out cat
 'The cat is crying, calling out, screaming.'

[55:25]: Discussion of Gitksan sign language and its revitalization.

[57:34]: Once again hard to tell the voiceless -'y but it seems to be there on a close listen.

- (23) 'wii'o'y 'niin
 'wii'o-'y 'niin
 love-1SG.II 2SG.III
 'I love you.'

[58:18]: Numerals. HH didn't seem to recognize *t'ipxaat* 'two.ANIM.'

- (24) ? *sdamkhl t'ipxaat duus*
 sdamk=hl t'ipxaat duus
 meow=CN two.ANIM cat
 Constructed (Z); intended: 'Two cats meowed'.

HH: "I think you use *bagadil* [BDM: 'two.HUM.']. Sometimes people say *gilbil* [BDM: 'two']. It depends on who is speaking ... dialect, Nisga'a or Tsimshian ... going to be mixed."

[59:43]:

- (25) *sdamkhl bagadil duus*
 sdamk=hl bagadil duus
 make.noise=CN two.HUM cat
 'Two cats meowed'.

[60:43]:

- (26) ? *bagadil sdamkhl duus*
 bagadil sdamk=hl duus
 two.HUM make.noise=CN cat
 Constructed (Z); intended: 'The cat meowed twice.'

HH: "Now you're saying that one cat meows twice." Offers instead:

[61:04]

- (27) *gilbil wint sdamkhl duus tun*
 gilbil win-t sdamk=hl duus t=x^win
 two COMP=3.I make.noise=CN cat PN=DEM.PROX
 'This cat meowed twice.' Comment: "That means only one cat."

Not 100% sure about *wint* here, but something like that. Doesn't sound like it's *gilba* 'twice.' Can't tell whether there are a couple more =*hl* after *gilbil* or with *win*.

[61:42]

- (28) *gilbil wint sdamkhl duus dipun*
 gilbil win-t sdamk=hl duus tip=x^win
 two COMP=3.I make.noise=CN cat PN=DEM-PROX
 'These two, or these three, or all these cats... all the cats meowed twice.'

HH: "Sometimes we don't use numbers, we use *dipun*, *dipus*. These, those. When we see them, then we say:"

[62:30]

- (29) *duus dipus*
 duus tip-ust
 cat DEM-DIST
 'all those cats'

Couldn't really hear the *t* at the end.

[62:38]

- (30) da'mist gabi duus sdamkit
 da'mist? gabi duus sdamk-it
 how.many? CNT.AMT cat make.noise-sx

'How many cats meowed?' Comment: "You don't see them but you hear them, so you question, 'how many?'"
 [Check if *-hl* on *gabi*.]

da'mist is listed as 'how many' in FV:Gitsenimx; not seeing it elsewhere. Maybe involves a contracted *hinda*? Would track with e.g. *Hindhahl gabit*? 'How many (are there)?', *Ndahl gabihl hapxwin*? 'How many (animals) did you trap?'. Also not hearing the *t* here. Could just be something different altogether. *gabi* 'how.many' is discussed in BDM. Similarly not sure if it ends in *t*.

[63:-]

- (31) ga'as Hector gilbilhl duus
 ga'a[-t]=s Hector gilbil=hl duus
 see[3.II]=PN Hector two=CN cat
 'Hector saw two cats.'

- (32) bagadil 'nis'im
 bagadil 'nis'im?
 two ??..III?
 "there's two of them"

Sounds a bit like 'nis'im but would expect 'nidiit?

HH: *gilbil* is animals or things.

[66:18]

- (33) ga'as Hector k'am gilbilhl duus
 ga'a[-t]=s Hector k'am gilbil=hl duus
 see[3.II]=PN Hector only two=CN cat

'Hector only saw two cats.' Comment: "So there is more but I only seen two. People are trying to show me, but I still can't see it, because I'm fixed on the two that I like."

- (34) k'am gilbil ga'at
 k'am gilbil ga'a-t
 only two=CN see-3.II
 'only seen/seeing two' [Check if *-hl* on *gilbil*.]

2 Elicitation 2026.10.01

Date: 2026.10.01
Consultant: Hector Hill / Gy'ax
Elicitors: Zahra, Andrew
Location: Second elicitation room
Context: First elicitation for LING 431/531 Field Methods
Audio: October_01_2026_HH.WAV

2.1 Matthias [0:00-35:00]

[0:43]: Found a first voices entry matching this, but I don't actually know its constituent parts. <https://www.firstvoices.com/gitzenimx/words/c3ac9f24-9731-4ea2-8290-d1b1b5e83dae>. There are a few entries using *waiy* as 'well', only found one where *woh* is also translated as 'well'.

(35) *waiy woh*
waiy woh
well well(?)
'Let's get started'

[1:33]: I don't actually know which part of my original prompt (*disiwilaaks 'niin*, which was ungrammatical) Hector was translating. I don't hear *ks* after *siwilaa*, instead it comes after *di-*. It makes no sense that *di-* appear where it does if this is monoclausal, but I am at a loss.

(36) *siwilaa di-ks-itxw*
learn di-ks-txw
learn COM-??-VAL
'Learn with someone (?)'

[2:14]: *gilbilhl smex* doesn't work without context, you have to add context, as Hector puts it "what were you doing, where did you see them, and why did you look for them".

[3:00]: This way you are still "not saying anything, there has to be some kind of accents before or after it." Hector wants to add *gya'a-y* after.

To me, this discussion points at the fact that numerals cannot act as direct predicates of nouns to be interpreted as e.g. existential constructions. Instead, it seems that there has to be another predicating element for Hector to accept the sentence. It is possible that this is due to impoverished context, however, it seems that Hector was rejecting these outright as valid sentences.

(37) *gilbil smex sapagayt gan ?(gya'ay)*
gilbil smex sapagayt gan ?(gya'a-y)
two bear amongst tree (see-1SG.II)
'(I saw) two bears in the forest'

[3:55]: Hector doesn't use *t'ipxaat* as 'two'.

[5:21]: Matthias' sentence, confirmed by Hector.

(38) *gya'ayhl gilbilhl smex*
gya'a-y=hl gilbil=hl smex
see-1SG.II=CN two=CN bear
'I saw two bears'

[5:32]: Hector seems to drop *hl* following *gilbil*. When I said (39) with *gilbilhl*, Hector specifically repeated it dropping *=hl*.

- (39) *gilbil smex gya'ay*
gilbil smex gya'a-y
 two bear see-1SG.II
 'I saw two bears'

[5:37]: Hector says that postpredicative (38) means some form of “excitement”, while prepredicative (39) can be said in neutral contexts. Could this intuition point to the fact that *gya'a-y* is focused in (38)? Hector adds phonological stress on the predicate when restating the sentence.

[7:36]:

- (40) a. *k'am gilbil smex gya'ay*
k'am gilbil smex gya'a-y
 only two bear see-1SG.II
 'I saw only two bears'
- b. *gya'ay k'am gilbil smex*
gya'a-y k'am gilbil smex
 see-1SG.II only two bear
 'I saw only two bears'

[8:00]: Both pre- and post-predicate *k'am* are “understandable”. Depends who you’re talking to...

[9:43]: Unsure about the translation of *gabi*. I haven’t found an independent use of it yet, only seeing it in the constructions *ndahl gabihl* or *hindahl gabihl*. [10:35] seems to show that you definitely need both of the *hl*, so it would also be interesting to see where Hector systematically drops *hl*.

- (41) *hindehl gabihl smex gya'an*
hinde=hl gabi=hl smex gya'a-n
 where=CN many=CN bear see-2SG.II
 'How many bears did you see?'

[11:18]: (39) is the “direct” answer to the question above. (38) is more “telling you what I’ve seen”. Can also answer with (40a).

Answering the question with simply *gilbil smex* is “not finished, but we know there’s two. [...] Kind of a nonchalant answer [...] if he really answered you it’d be with the first or second one [the full sentences]”.

[14:30]: Using Davis (2026: 84) which defines *=aa* as a sentence level enclitic, acting as a polar marker. Apparently, for neutral questions *nee* is used alongside *=aa*, but Hector seems fine with the translating the question with simply *=aa*?

- (42) *gilbil smex gya'anaa*
gilbil smex gya'a-n=aa
 two bear see-2SG.II=Q
 'Did you see two bears?'

[16:20]:

- (43) a. *guphl smexhl maa'y*
gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
 eat=CN bear=CN berries
 'The bear(s) ate berries'
- b. *yukwhl guphl smex maa'y*
yukw=hl gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
 PROG=CN eat=CN bear=CN berries
 'The bear(s) are eating berries'

- c. yukwhl gipguphl smex maa'y
 yukw=hl gip~gup=hl smex=hl maa'y
 PROG=CN PL~eat=CN bear=CN berries
 'The bear(s) are eating the berries'

[17:40]: Now this is interesting. Davis (2026: 80) shows that *an* is the A-extraction marker, moreover, fn. 86 says that HH frequently deletes =*t*, exactly what we see in the second example.

What's fascinating is that we have what should be the head [*gilbil smex*] separated from the RC [*an guphl maa'y*] by the matrix verb *gya'ay*. It seems that this strongly supports a movement analysis of [*gilbil smex*] to a pre-predicative position.

Note that Hector first says the sentence without *an*, but it feels like he corrects himself later since he is saying it while processing, so I will tentatively assume that *an* is still necessary in this construction.

- (44) bagadil/gilbil smex gya'ay an guphl maa'y
 bagadil/gilbil smex gya'a-y an gup=hl maa'y
 HUM.two/two bear see-2SG.II AX eat=CN berries
 'I seen two bears eating berries'

[20:22]: "It's almost out of place, but it's understandable that you've seen two bears eating berries". If using *gipguphl* it means a lot of berries.

- (45) ?? gilbil smex an guphl maa'y gya'ay
 gilbil smex an gup=hl maa'y gya'a-y
 two bear AX eat=CN berries see-2SG.II
 Intended: 'I saw two bears eating berries'

[20:49]: In response to above, Hector offers this.

- (46) gya'ay gilbil smex an guphl maa'y
 gya'a-y gilbil smex an gup=hl maa'y
 see-2SG.II two bear AX eat=CN berries
 'I saw two bears eating berries'

[21:16]: I think I hear the attributive *-m* after *sgan*.

- (47) sganim maa'y
 sgan-m maa'y
 bush-ATTR berries
 'bush/branch of berries'

[21:35]:

[35:50]:

[]: hilthl t'uuts'xw-m smex (g'a'ay) loot
 Lots of black bears there.

[]: (yukw) wok=hl ['wii t'uuts'xw-it smex] / (k'yoots)
 sleep=CN big black-SX bear
 The big black bear is sleeping.

[]: (ga'a'y) / (yukw) hadiks=hl ['wii t'uuts'xw-m smex] (k'yoots)
 swim=CN big black-SX bear
 The big black bear is swimming.

[]: t'uuts'xw-m smex hadiks-it

black-ATTR bear swim-SX

The bear that is swimming is black.

"If the other brown bear or the black bear is still standing."

[]: t'uuts'xw=hl smex wok-it

black=CN bear sleep-SX

The bear that is sleeping is black.

[]: gya'a'y=hl hild-a hun

see-1SG.II=CN many-ATTR fish

I saw many fish.

→ Answers a question, somewhere where there's no fish, no water. You're telling a story. Might be surprising that I saw them.

[]: hild-a gya'a'y=hl hun

many-ATTR see-1SG.II=CN fish

I saw fish many times.

[53:50]:

(48) jehl-?=hl Gitanyow Kispiox

beat-?=hl Gitanyow Kispiox

'Gitanyow beat [=made lose] Kispiox.' [causative obscured by connective?]

[54:00]:

(49) yukwhl hlithl Kispiox gan Gitanyow 'ii jehl Kispiox.

PROG soccer Kispiox and Gitanyow and lose Kispiox

'Kispiox and Gitanyow were playing soccer, and Kispiox lost'.

hlit 'soccer'. *xsd* 'win'.

(50) k'i'y win jehl Kispiox[hl ?] Gitanyow.

one COMP lose Kispiox Gitanyow

'Kispiox lost by one from Gitanyow'.

(51) gwile'l[] win xsdaahl Gitanyow 'ii k'am gilbil jephil Kispiox.

three COMP win[=score] Gitanyow and only two make Kispiox

'Gitanyow scored three times and Kispiox only scored twice'.

References

Davis, Henry. 2026. The Morphosyntax of Gitksan: A Grammatical Sketch with Examples from 'Nit Gan Wilt.